

**SEASON 01 EPISODE 03**

To Care for a Family

A grown rabbit, ERNIE, sits alone in a room with her parents.

MOTHER

Ernie. You take care of them, huh?

Ernie doesn't nod. She just sits with her MOTHER.

Her FATHER, behind, is on oxygen, running out of time.

MOTHER

You take care of your family.

Ernie ignores her. Eyes downcast.

MOTHER

We are at war, huh, Ernie?

Ernie shakes her head, subtle, shaking off her mother's words.

MOTHER

We are at war, and I need you to shield your siblings from-

ERNIE

Mama. You are making me wish.

Mother turns her head.

ERNIE

I wish my ears were smaller.

Mother glares, flicks her daughter's arm.

MOTHER

You listen to me.

But Ernie shrinks, hunches.

Her mother sees that. Her eyelids lower in resignation. She turns her head away.

Ernie shoves herself out of her seat and STORMS out of the room.

Ernie huddles with her younger sister. EVE.

EVE

Ernie, where's Lori and Geri?

ERNIE

They're not coming with us.

Eve leans into her sister.

EVE  
And Clem?  
(beat)  
Ernie, I miss Clem.

Ernie takes out a pair of earbuds.

ERNIE  
Me too.

She places one in Eve's left ear-

And one in her own right ear.

It plays, muffled.

**3 EXT. MAINLAND - DAY**

**3**

The bus crosses golden fields, wild forests, dark underpasses.

**4 EXT. HIGHWAY 96 - DAY**

**4**

A sign: "WELCOME TO TALENS." The bus halts.

Ernie steps out with her sister.

CUT TO BLACK.

**5 INT. LOUIS'S HOUSE - DAY**

**5**

Outside a window: LOUIS- a grizzly bear- plays ball with his labrador friend, JUNIPER, at the house across the street.

On the porch, watching them, is JANE- Juniper's mother.

HENRY, Louis's father, glances through at it all.

He sighs.

**6 INT. LOUIS'S HOUSE - NIGHT**

**6**

The family over dinner.

HENRY  
You're making friends now, Louis?

Louis doesn't respond. The family is still fresh from the parents' argument.

BELINDA, Louis's mother, rips out from the halibut.

BELINDA  
He has a friend. His name's Juniper,  
actually.

HENRY  
I know that. I've been paying  
attention.

Hazel tenses up, her shoulders inward, as she bites.

BELINDA  
Look, you're making her upset now.

HENRY  
Hazel, how about you? How are your  
friends?

Louis glances away, ears lowered.

He grabs them.

LATER THAT NIGHT:

**7 EXT. LOUIS'S HOUSE - NIGHT**

**7**

Belinda and Henry yelling, incoherent, muffled.

Jane watching, squinting. She brings out the phone.

JANE  
Sweetie? They're yelling again.  
(laughs)  
I'm glad we're not like them.  
(nods)  
Yeah. They'll be here tomorrow. Love  
you. Bye.

Jane ends the call. She gets up, glances at Louis's home-  
then SHUTS THE DOOR.

**8 INT. JUNIPER'S HOUSE - DAY**

**8**

Jane walks through the house. A solemn piano creeps in as  
we realize:

Juniper's family is moving out.

JANE  
June, can you help me?

Juniper places portraits in boxes.

JANE  
Attaboy.

JUNIPER  
Mom?

JANE

Yes?

JUNIPER

Is that Louis's mom and dad every night?

JANE

(kisses)

Don't worry. It is. But we'll be out of here soon.

JUNIPER

Mom?

Jane turns to Juniper.

JUNIPER

Will I get to be friends with Louis still?

Jane doesn't answer. She takes a portrait down.

On the portrait: WEALTHY BUSINESSMEN. Juniper's father and uncles.

She glances down.

JANE

What does it mean? Being friends with Louis? Does it mean a lot or a little?

JUNIPER

A lot. I like playing with him.

Jane pauses.

JANE

Well too bad.

A beat.

She continues taking down furniture. Juniper sits on the ground.

**9 EXT. LOUIS'S HOUSE - DAY**

**9**

Louis wakes up to a BEEP! BEEP! BEEP!

Then a knock.

BELINDA OPENS.

BELINDA

Hello there!

Juniper steps back.

BELINDA  
What do you have there?

JUNIPER  
I wanna see Louis.

BELINDA  
Here, I'll call him for you-

LOUIS  
June!

Louis runs out, tackles Juniper. They hug, chuckling on Louis's porch.

Louis glances ahead at Juniper's place.

LOUIS  
What's that?

Belinda turns around, closes the door.

JUNIPER  
Mom said we're moving away.

LOUIS  
Where to?

JUNIPER  
I don't know yet. But she says  
somewhere safer.

LOUIS  
(soft)  
Oh.

JUNIPER  
Can we play one last game before I  
leave?

Louis pockets his shock. He slowly curls his mouth to a smile.

LOUIS  
S-sure!

Louis and Juniper play, this time on Louis's garage.

PANG! PANG! PANG!

Louis and Juniper laugh.

They play for hours.

Then, as the sun sets:

JANE

June!

JUNIPER

Yes, Mom!

Juniper waves goodbye to Louis. He rushes to the car.

Suddenly, Belinda bursts out from the house.

BELINDA

Wait!

Belinda walks up to the car. She knocks.

BELINDA

M-my kid, he really values his  
friendship with your...

JANE

My June.

Belinda hands Jane her phone number.

BELINDA

I'm sorry to be meeting like this. I  
wanted to get your number.

**10 INT. LOUIS'S HOUSE - DAY**

**10**

Henry sits on the couch, hands folded over his lap.

**11 EXT. LOUIS'S HOUSE - DAY**

**11**

Jane's eyes dart. She contemplates saying yes.

Louis watches.

JANE

412-376...

BELINDA

376...

Just then, Hazel turns the corner.

Belinda's kind face contorts to anger.

Hazel runs away. Belinda catches up to her.

BELINDA

Where have you been?

HAZEL

It's not like you care.

BELINDA  
You've been gone all day.

HAZEL  
Mom, I'm not doing anything crazy.  
Will you shut up? Who's that?

Belinda turns around at Jane. Her expression softens.

Jane glances at the road, dissociated. She shifts into gear-

BELINDA  
Wait!

Belinda runs up to Jane.

BELINDA  
Hey! Hey, look, I'm sorry, my kid,  
she's been gone all day-

JANE  
You need to behave your kids, ma'am.

BELINDA  
376?

JANE  
You need to get them in line.

BELINDA  
376? 376 what? 376 what's the rest?  
What's the fucking rest?!

JANE  
Like I said, in line!

Jane drives off, tailing the move-in truck.

LOUIS  
Mom!

Hazel cups her mouth.

The car disappears, leaving:

A vacant house in the distance.

Belinda heaves, heavy exhale after exhale, exhausted.

Hazel finds Louis. She glances at her mother, bewildered.

Then at Louis. Louis is holding Juniper's ball. He's staring at it.

Hazel's bewilderment fades.



HAZEL  
Lighten up.

Hazel pats Louis on the shoulder supportively. Louis smiles, again.

**12 INT. LOUIS'S HOUSE - NIGHT**

**12**

Henry and Belinda sit, quiet.

HENRY  
Salt?

Belinda passes the salt.

HENRY  
Thanks.  
(clears throat)  
How was everyone's day?

HAZEL  
(nods)  
Good. I just played cards.

LOUIS  
(smiles)  
I played with June.

The house goes quiet again.

**13 INT. LOUIS'S HOUSE - DAY**

**13**

Louis opens his eyes. But this time he doesn't hear the familiar PANG of a ball.

He glances at the corner of the room, at Juniper's dodgeball.

And he cries.

One tear after another. His cry turns into sobs.

Hazel gets up and leaves the room, SLAMMING the door. She runs into the bathroom.

In the living room, Belinda and Henry lay on the couches, away.

Belinda sits up.

Henry does. Belinda holds out her hand, as their kid cries.

HENRY  
I guess people are listening.

Belinda nods. Slow.

BELINDA  
 From now on... We have to keep all  
 our shit to ourselves. We can yell  
 all we want, but not in front of the  
 kids. Can we agree on that?

Henry nods.

HENRY  
 Can we whisper?

Belinda nods.

HENRY  
 Okay.

BELINDA  
 Love you.

HENRY  
 (a beat)  
 Love you.

Henry pats Belinda.

HENRY  
 Let's get ready for work.

**14      EXT. LOUIS'S HOUSE - DAY      14**

Henry and Belinda leave the house. Louis and Hazel shortly  
 after.

**15      EXT. TRAIN TRACKS - DAY      15**

Louis and Hazel no longer hold hands. They cross the  
 tracks, Louis trailing behind.

**16      INT. WESTSIDE ELEMENTARY - DAY      16**

Louis buries his head as the rest of the kids play.

Mrs. MARCHECK- the teacher- glances his way. She frowns,  
 glances in the rabbits' direction.

The rabbit who bullied Louis acts normal.

Marcheck continues to work.

**17      EXT. WESTSIDE ELEMENTARY - DAY      17**

Hazel sits on the bleachers. No one's out. Class is in  
 session.

Beside her: SIENNA and KODY, black and kermode bears.

They play slapjack.

KODY

Dad used to spank me when I was 8.

SIENNA

Oh yeah? Dad pulled the chair out from under my ass last month.

KODY

While you were eating? Bruh, who had it worse, Hazel? Me or Sienna?

HAZEL

(chuckles)

Why the fuck are you guys competing?

SIENNA

We're not competing. We're just stating the facts.

Sienna SLAPS a double jack.

KODY

Just the facts.

SLAP. Sienna and Hazel's hands land on each other.

Hazel glances up at Sienna. They make eye contact.

KODY

Hazel was first.

Hazel slowly slides the card back to her deck.

SIENNA

(scoffs)

Sure.

Sienna clears his throat, shifts.

Hazel laughs.

MONTAGE:

Time speeds up as card game after card game skips itself.

**18 INT. WESTSIDE ELEMENTARY - DAY**

**18**

Louis spends his time in the corner of the room.

**19 INT. HAIR SALON - DAY**

**19**

Belinda continues cutting hair, cutting precise despite her large hands.

20      **INT. TAILOR SHOP - DAY**      20

Henry lets in customer after customer, working his large fingers down hemlines.

21      **INT. LOUIS'S HOUSE - DAY**      21

Marking off day by day...

22      **INT. WESTSIDE ELEMENTARY - DAY**      22

Until it's time for middle school promotion.

Hazel sits with Sienna and Kody.

HAZEL

What high school are you going to?

KODY

As in, like, public or private?

SIENNA

There's only public high schools here, dumbass. Nearest private one is like 30 miles away. Ain't nobody gonna make it to that one.

KODY

Except for all the rich kids.

HAZEL

Yeah, so which public highschool. There's like three.

SIENNA

Talens High.

HAZEL

Thank you. Thank you.  
(looks at Kody)  
You?

KODY

Talens.

Sienna and Kody look at each other, then at Hazel.

SIENNA

And you?

HAZEL

Probably talens.

Kody smiles. He nudges Sienna on the arm.

HAZEL

Not because of you guys.

SIENNA

Then why?

HAZEL

'Cause it's closer to home, that's why.

But to the side, Hazel smiles.

MOMENTS LATER:

ANNOUNCER

Hazel Belmone!

Hazel walks across the stage. She comes face-to-face with the principal.

PRINCIPAL

Good job!

Hazel pauses. She hesitates. She nearly doesn't shake his hand.

But she caves.

The audience claps.

From the audience, Louis watching.

LOUIS

Go Hazel!

Hazel looks out at Louis's family. Smiles.

**23 EXT. GRILLZY'S - DAY**

**23**

The family stands outside the restaurant, with the tacky logo of a BEAR.

**24 INT. GRILLZY'S - DAY**

**24**

A rabbit walks up to the family. ERNIE. Dressed in uniform.

ERNIE

Could I take your order?

And for a moment, the family goes silent.

BELINDA

Mainlander's meal for one family, please?

Ernie nods. She returns.

HENRY  
(whispering)  
Look. Another one of those rabbits.

Belinda glances off to the side.

BEHIND:

Ernie heads back.

ERNIE  
Mainlander's meal! Large!

Ernie nearly BUMPS into a hippo.

HIPPO  
Don't block the hallways, Ernie!

ERNIE  
You nearly stepped on- ugh!

Ernie goes behind the kitchen, slams her hat down.

A bell RINGS.

MANAGER  
We have four tables waiting to be  
seated! Ernie, where the hell are  
you?

Ernie travels, bussing and waiting multiple people. Over  
and over again.

A family of dogs sits at the bar.

DOG  
Would you please smile next time you  
take your order? Maybe it'll make me  
feel *nicer*.

Ernie stares at the dog. She heads backstage.

DOG  
So rude...

Louis notices. He watches the rabbit head backstage.

BELINDA  
What is taking them so long?

Hazel takes off her hat.

Belinda raises her hand.

HENRY  
No. Don't.

HAZEL

Can you guys stop arguing? It's fine.

Belinda and Henry lower their hands.

BELINDA

Hazel, look. I just wanted to say that I'm really proud of you.

Hazel frowns, bites her lip, looks away.

HENRY

We. We're proud of you. Both of us.

BELINDA

(nods)

We may not be the best at it, but we're trying.

HAZEL

Mom, I feel like shit.

Belinda nods. Henry claps his hands.

Ernie turns the corner.

BUT A LARGE ANIMAL BUMPS INTO HER.

CRASH! The family meal comes crashing down.

HENRY

Fucking Christ, why us? Waiter! Watier!

BELINDA

Waiter!

Ernie glances up, panicking. She makes eye contact with Louis.

Behind the counter:

MANAGER

Why? Did you not call out "clear" when you got out?

ERNIE

No, I forgot, I forgot! Okay?!

The manager shakes his head. He sighs.

MANAGER

Ernie.

ERNIE

Please, please, please. I need this.

MANAGER

Go, go back to the tables, apologize to everyone.

Ernie heads to each family, one by one.

Belinda and Hazel glare at her.

ERNIE

I'm sorry. 20 minutes?

(next)

10? 15?

(next)

Please, just 7. 8.

Ernie stands before the family of dogs.

ERNIE

Just five minutes.

DOG

My god, people have no manners these days. You have to make us wait five minutes for our meal?

The dog COCKS her head.

Belinda and Henry glance over.

DOG

You know what? I don't think you deserve this job, this role, because it requires basic human decency, something you clearly don't have-

Ernie, with all the yelling, anger, stares-

Locks in.

ERNIE

(sob story voice)

I'm sorry, I just- I lost this locket last week and it was super important to me. You know, it belonged to my great aunt, and before that my great great aunt, and before that my great great great grandma! And it was the last thing my aunt gave me before she passed away, so I've been so- you know- out of it today, so please excuse me for five more minutes.

Ernie nods, trying really hard to sell her story.

The dog shifts, shocked, then frowning in shame.



DOG  
 (empathetic)  
 Oh my god, I'm sorry to hear that. I  
 hope you find your locket.

Ernie- shocked- blinks. Then snaps back into it.

ERNIE  
 Thank you.

Behind the counter, she tosses her hat down. She slowly  
 wheels lunch to Louis's family.

They're quiet. Clearly no one bought the story. But they  
 get it.

Ernie passes them the plates one by one.

The restaurant is talkative, but Louis's family goes  
 quiet.

Then Hazel bursts into quiet laughter. Then Louis, then  
 Belinda, then Henry.

They laugh their asses off.

BELINDA  
 (quiet)  
 Wow.

Hazel smiles as she eats the food.

Ernie turns around, noticing the family's laugh. She  
 smirks. Someone else gets it.

She heads to the kitchen.

Louis's family leaves. Ernie watches them, cleaning the  
 spill.

Later, her shift ends.

**25 INT. LOUIS'S CAR - DAY**

**25**

The car moves quietly.

BELINDA  
 She was clearly lying.

HENRY  
 Oh yeah. As soon as that dog heard  
 her story, he 180'ed.

BELINDA  
 Lie to the rich, I guess.

The family travels down the road. Louis glances out the window, but he realizes he's a bit taller.

He has to lean to see the clouds.

HAZEL

She really went in. I'm kind of impressed.

Belinda and Henry laugh. Hazel smiles.

**26 EXT. LOUIS'S HOUSE - DAY**

**26**

The car parks.

Louis leaves the car. He glances at the empty house across from him. He frowns, but glances at his sister.

Hazel, in cap and gown, smiling for the first time in a long time with his aprents.

Louis smiles.

**27 INT. LOUIS'S HOUSE - NIGHT**

**27**

The family settles down, hanging up portraits of Hazel's graduation...

As Hazel heads to bed.

**28 EXT. DOWNTOWN - NIGHT**

**28**

Ernie leaves Grillzy's, takeout in hand.

**29 INT. EVE'S HOME - NIGHT**

**29**

Ernie dumps food on the counter. Humming in the background:

EVE, her younger sister. Louis's age.

On the old TV, a singer. A secretarybird, subtitled ADELINE.

Eve hums.

EVE

Did anyone order an hour before closing again?

ERNIE

(sigh)

Thank god, no. But I did spill, like, an entire meal.

Ernie glances at a guitar at the corner of the room.

EVE  
Thought Grillzy's closes at 9.

ERNIE  
Why, 'cause you wanted to wake up  
the neighbors again?

EVE  
(rolls eyes, laughs)  
No one's sleeping at 8PM.

ERNIE  
Well, 7 ate 9, and you need to eat  
so you don't starve. Food on the  
counter!

EVE  
Thank you!

Eve runs out. She sits on the table.

It's quiet outside.

ERNIE  
What did you read?

EVE  
Another poli-sci book. This one's  
about reptiles.

Reptiles. Ernie stares at her food.

ERNIE  
What did you learn?

EVE  
That reptiles used to live on the  
mainland, but the mainland became  
uninhabitable.

ERNIE  
Really?

EVE  
Yeah, it's cool.

Eve's stomach gurbles. She takes a bite out of a large  
carrot.

There are at least twenty in the meal.

ERNIE  
I wanted to talk to you about  
something.

30     **EXT. GRILLZY'S - DAY**

30

Hazel in her robe.

31     **INT. EVE'S HOME - NIGHT**

31

          ERNIE

          In a few years, people your age will  
          be graduating from elementary  
          school.

Eve eats, inattentive.

          ERNIE

          They'll be moving onto high school.

Eve grabs another bite, practically scarfing.

          ERNIE

          You hear me?

Eve nods, still scarfing. Ernie grabs a bite.

          ERNIE

          So I wanted to get you registered-

          EVE

          Do we have the money?

          ERNIE

          Yes. Yes we do.

Ernie takes off her Grillzy's cap- stares at it.

          ERNIE

          Four years, public high school.

          EVE

          Now?

          ERNIE

          No. In two years. But I wanted to  
          ask you ahead of time.

Eve shakes her head.

          ERNIE

          Eve, I promise, it'll be good for  
          you. Really good.

Eve's leg gets restless.

          EVE

          I'm fine being homeschooled.

ERNIE

I know you are, but if- but I think  
you should get some kind of idea for  
how society works so that when the  
day comes that I'm not around,  
you're properly socialized.

Eve frowns.

ERNIE

You need friends outside of just me.  
Okay, little sister?

Eve continues to eat. She pushes her meal aside.

She stares at the ground.

EVE

(hesitant)

Okay.

ERNIE

Okay?

Eve nods. Ernie pulls her in.

ERNIE

Soon.

Ernie lets go. Eve heads to the bedroom. Closes the door.

Guitar strums behind the thin wall.

Ernie finishes the rest of Eve's meal. She walks toward  
the kitchen.

She glances at a portrait of her family. Her mother, her  
father, her, Eve, and three other siblings.

**32 INT. LOUIS'S HOUSE - NIGHT**

**32**

Louis and Hazel glance at the wall. They hang up a  
portrait of Hazel.

BELINDA

You're next, Louis, eh?

LOUIS

Yeah.

Louis stares across the street, at Juniper, distant.

Behind, in the bedroom:

HAZEL SNEAKS OUT.

33     **EXT. LOUIS'S HOUSE - NIGHT**

33

She runs to the park.

34     **EXT. PARK - NIGHT**

34

Hazel sits with Sienna. Just Sienna.

SIENNA

So did you convince your family?

HAZEL

Yeah. I'm going to Talens High, and  
so is my brother.

SIENNA

Cool.

HAZEL

Where's Kody?

SIENNA

Didn't ask.

HAZEL

Ask next time.

Hazel and Sienna sit side by side, on the benches.

SIENNA

I picked Talens High 'cause it was  
the closest to your home.

The wind blows. Hazel stays quiet.

Sienna takes out a small container.

SIENNA

Wanted to show you this.

He opens it. It's a pen.

A dap pen.

HAZEL

What's that?

SIENNA

I'll show you.

Sienna takes a big hit, then blows it out.

Hazel follows- takes a big hit, then blows it out.

She calms down.

HAZEL

Woah...

SIENNA

Yeah...

The two of them lean on the bench, an immense calm hanging over them.

HAZEL

This feels good.

SIENNA

Fuck yeah, it does. You wanna lay on the grass?

Hazel starts cackling.

SIENNA

(laughing)

This shit feels weird, doesn't it?

Hazel laughs.

SIENNA

Alright.

Sienna takes out a deck of cards. He shuffles them, high, then passes one to Hazel.

SIENNA

Hit or stay?

HAZEL

S-stay.

Sienna passes one.

SIENNA

Hit or stay?

HAZEL

(chuckles)

Hit.

The two play at the park.

**35 INT. LOUIS'S HOUSE - NIGHT**

**35**

Belinda and Henry sit at the table, waiting for Hazel to go home. On the TV:

"PRESIDENT BULLOCK IN NEGOTIATION WITH SENATE"

ANNOUNCER

Bullock is currently in a deadlock  
(MORE)

ANNOUNCER (CONT'D)  
 with the senate over the proposed  
 salary bill for animals of different  
 species...

Henry gulps. Belinda sits at the dinner table, quiet.

The door opens. It's Hazel.

She falls onto the couch, slow. She begins snoring.

Not realizing their daughter is high, Henry and Belinda  
 nod at each other.

They get up and head to bed. Belinda walks to Hazel, to  
 get close and kiss her on the forehead-

But pauses. Stops. Turns to her room and shuts the door.

The lights turn off.

**36 INT. LOUIS'S HOUSE - NIGHT**

**36**

Louis tucks himself in. He stares at Hazel's spot.

Then he stares at Juniper's ball.

Then he stares at the ceiling.

Crickets and silence.

Louis pulls out a sketchbook. He flips page after page.

On one page is a redraw of his family. Mommy, Daddy,  
 Hazel. But this time: "Mom, Dad, Sis."

He flips. The angry rabbit.

He flips. Him and Juniper.

He flips. The next page is blank.

He tries to draw his sister's robe. He throws line after  
 line, dash after dash.

A track of solence kicks in as Louis sketches away, losing  
 himself in the simplicity of it all.

**37 EXT. LOUIS'S HOUSE - NIGHT**

**37**

Until the final light goes off.

**38 EXT. EVE'S HOME - NIGHT**

**38**

Eve's light goes off.



**39      EXT. DOWNTOWN - NIGHT**

**39**

And the city sleeps.

Beep... Beep... Beep...

**40      INT. BUS - DAY**

**40**

An older Eve leans on the window pane of the bus, leaving  
her city...

As the flatline of her parents echoes like a ghost.

CUT TO BLACK.